

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6 5 2
 ♥ A 9 6 2
 ♦ 10 8 3
 ♣ K 3

♠ A K 3

♥ K 4

♦ A K 6 5

♣ J 7 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 4

♥ Q J 8 7 3

♦ J 9 4

♣ 9 4

♠ Q 10 7

♥ 10 5

♦ Q 7 2

♣ A Q 10 8 5

West

North

East

South

1♦

Pass

2♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

far and you have 4 more winners ready to take. So you can take your 9 tricks and run, or you can finesse the ♣ trying for 3 overtricks.

It's your decision, but </br></br>

At Rubber Bridge or Team play it would probably be foolish to risk your contract for the sake of three overtricks.

But at Match Point Pairs the reward would be much greater, a probable very high board. Of course with this layout it might have gotten you a bottom board.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥7. West takes the ♥A and returns the ♥2.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=3 ♣=1 Total = 8

You need one more winner and ♣s is your best suit. If the ♣K is in East's hand you can finesse it for 12 tricks. But if the ♣K is in West's hand you will lose that trick and at least 4 ♥s.

Before you put all your eggs in the ♣ finesse basket there is one thing you should do first.

You should test the ♦ suit by playing ♦Q, ♦K, ♦A. Both defenders follow three times and your ♦6 has become a winner, which you cash.

Now you have a problem. You have won 5 tricks so far and you have 4 more winners ready to take. So you can take your 9 tricks and run, or you can finesse the ♣ trying for 3 overtricks.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 6 3
 ♥ 7 5 2
 ♦ A 7 5 3
 ♣ 10 5 4

♠ K 9

♥ 10 8 6

♦ K J 9

♣ 8 7 6 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 7 4

♥ A K

♦ 10 8 6 2

♣ A K Q

♠ 10 8 5 2

♥ Q J 9 4 3

♦ Q 4

♣ J 9

West

North

East

South

2♦

Pass

1♦

3NT

Pass

All Pass

3NT by East

and then a small ♠ back toward your ♠ Q J. Here North puts the ♠ K on and you are home-free.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♥ Q.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 7

You need two more winners and ♦ s is your longest combined suit. But you can only establish one extra winner in ♦ s, and before you could even do that the defenders would have taken a bunch of ♥ tricks.

So you must turn to the ♠ s for the extra two winners.

You win the first ♥ and lead . . . which ♠? If you play the ♠ Q you will go down, even if South has the ♠ K. He would cover and you would be held to just 2 ♠ tricks.

The only way to get 3 tricks from this holding is to play North for the ♠ K. So play a ♠ to dummy's ♠ A

You were a little lucky that North's ♠ K fell on the second round.

If it had not dropped you would just have played a third round of ♠ s, hoping for a 3-3 split in the suit.

Clickagain.

You could also have gotten 3 ♠ winners with this distribution.